

CALIMESA FIRE DEPARTMENT
POLICY MANUAL
VOLUME 1 - ADMINISTRATION
Policy: 102.03 Job Description

11/2023

FIRE BATTALION CHIEF
\$70,128.24 – \$89,503.38 Annually

DEPARTMENT: FIRE DEPARTMENT

FLSA STATUS: EXEMPT

POSITION STATUS: REGULAR FULL-TIME

REPORTS TO: FIRE CHIEF

DEFINITION

Under the administrative direction of the Fire Chief assist with management and coordination of the operations and services of the Fire Department which may include, but not limited to, recommendation of policy and procedures, training, EMS communications, records, support services and fire safety technical services functions. Supervise and serve as chief field officer in directing the response, readiness, and activities of multiple fire companies.

DISTINGUISHING CHARACTERISTICS

The Battalion Chief is a management level class within the fire safety class series and has responsibility for managing, supervising and coordinating all organizational and operational facets of the fire protective service. This classification is distinguished from the next lower classification of Fire Captain in that it has management responsibility for the entire Fire Department in the absence of the Fire Chief.

ESSENTIAL JOB FUNCTIONS

- Accept management responsibility for activities, operations, and services of an assigned shift including the areas of fire prevention, fire suppression, training, inspection, investigations, and emergency medical aid services.
- Oversee and/or participate in the development, implementation and maintenance of the shift goals, objectives, policies, and procedures; ensure that divisional goals are achieved.
- Assign materials and equipment to achieve maximum efficiency in response time; provide administrative and technical direction to shift personnel.
- Coordinate the selection, orientation, training, and evaluation programs for shift personnel; provide or coordinate staff training; identify and resolve staff deficiencies; fulfill discipline procedures.
- Commands firefighting activities in response to fire alarms; determines route to be taken; decides on the methods of combating fires; directs firefighting until relieved by the Fire Chief.
- Make periodic personnel inspections and general inspections of vehicles, apparatus, and fire stations.

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- Supervises training in EMS, ropes and knots, street layouts and locations, hydrants, hydraulics, building construction and firefighting techniques and skills; demonstrates the use of firefighting equipment apparatus.
- Develops driving programs, investigates job related injuries to prevent reoccurrence; evaluates firefighting operations to determine training needs and prevention of unsafe acts; evaluates all safety equipment.
- Maybe assigned to oversee the departments ALS/EMS program.
- Oversee and participate in the development of the department budget; participate in the forecast of necessary funds for staffing, materials, and supplies.
- Propose, present, and justify programs, projects, operations and services.
- Develop a strategy and work plan for the successful achievement of program and project goals.
- Serve as a resource for shift personnel and other Fire Department personnel.
- Coordinate shift and departmental activities with other departments and organizations.
- Provide information and resources to City officials, departments and other organizations as is appropriate.
- Conduct financial, organizational, and operational service delivery studies; make recommendations to address and resolve identified service delivery issues.
- Coordinate mutual and automatic aid programs with other jurisdictions.
- Attend and participate in organizational and community meetings as necessary.
- Stay current on issues relative to the fire service field.
- Respond to and resolve community and organizational inquiries and complaints.
- Direct the preparation and maintenance of statistical and activity reports regarding emergency incidents, fire prevention, fire investigations and inspection activities.
- Prepare and present staff reports and necessary documents or correspondence to the Fire Chief.
- Performs other related duties as required.

MINIMUM QUALIFICATIONS

Experience

Any combination of education and experience that has provided the knowledge, skills and abilities for a Battalion Chief. A typical way of obtaining the required qualification is to possess the equivalent of ten (7) years of increasingly responsible experience in all phases of fire suppression, prevention and emergency medical services including three (3) years supervisory experience. A high school diploma or equivalent is required.

Education

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High School Diploma or Equivalent; and
Bachelor's degree from an accredited college or university with major course work in fire science or a related field; or
California Chief Fire Officer Certificate with an associate degree in a related field

Knowledge and Skills

Knowledge of the principles and practices of fire prevention and suppression, fire department organization and operations, and Federal, State, municipal, and Department related policies and procedures use and maintenance of firefighting equipment and apparatus; pre-fire planning inspection methods; the principles of supervision and training, including the administration of the Firefighter Bill of Rights; proper work scheduling and the standards of productivity for a fire company; mutual aid and cooperative response areas; hazardous materials; sources and references in the firefighting fields; fire prevention planning and methods; working knowledge of The City of Calimesa geography, organization and fiscal operations, fire hazards, and firefighting resources such as personnel, equipment, water supply, and other departments; first aid procedures; problem-solving principles (gathering and evaluating information, identifying problems); information management and recordkeeping, computer applications, software or data processing systems used for fire operations, forms and report development.

Ability to operate all types of firefighting equipment and apparatus; allocate resources in the administration and maintenance of a fire station and fire/emergency medical operations; instruct others in fire suppression operations under normal and emergency or hazardous conditions; supervise, evaluate and train assigned staff; maintain effective productivity, discipline, and morale; keep records and prepare reports accurately, establish and maintain effective working relationships; perform duties requiring physical endurance and agility; maintain calm and good judgment under stressful conditions; this includes relating effectively and courteously with colleagues, city staff, and the public

Ability to communicate clearly and effectively both orally and in writing; including the ability to communicate effectively to staff and the public on decisions, changes, and other relevant information in a timely manner, effectively and calmly de-escalate a variety of potentially dangerous or problematic issues; comprehend lengthy and complicated reports and fire service or department material; prepare and present clear, comprehensive and well-organized reports, efficiently organize, schedule, and complete multiple tasks and work projects within prescribed deadlines; properly interpret and make decisions in accordance with laws, regulations, procedures, standards, and policies; use a computer and a variety of software programs, and interpret, explain, apply, and enforce a variety of rules and regulations.

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Certifications

- Driver/ Operator 1A
- Driver/ Operator 1B
- Fire Control 3
- Auto Extrication
- Hazmat FRO
- S-130 Firefighter Training
- S-190 Introduction to Wildland Fire Behavior
- ICS 100
- ICS 200
- ICS 300
- Low Angle Rope Rescue
- National Incident Management System (NIMS) IS-700
- National Incident Management System (NIMS) IS-800
- Fire Fighter I
- Company Officer
- Chief Fire Officer (Completion within Probationary Period)

AND

- Fire Command 1A
- Fire Command 1B
- Fire Command 1C
- Training Instructor 1B or Fire Instructor 1A
- Training Instructor 1A or Fire Instructor 1B
- Fire Investigation 1A
- Fire Management 1
- Fire Prevention 1A

OR

- Company Officer 2A
- Company Officer 2B
- Company Officer 2C
- Company Officer 2D
- Company Officer 2E
- Instructor I

Licenses

- Valid California Class C Driver's License with Firefighter Endorsement or California Commercial Class A or B with air brake and tank endorsement
- Valid State of California EMT-1

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- Valid American Heart Association CPR Healthcare Professional/ Basic Life Support (BLS)
- Valid Firefighter's Physical Ability Test consisting of a Biddle or CPAT

DESIRED QUALIFICATIONS

- Knowledge of Microsoft Office software applications
- Preparing and maintaining accurate reports and records
- Establish and maintain effective working relationships with city staff, elected officials and the public.
- Communicate effectively.
- Use standard office equipment including personal computer, fax, copier, calculator.
- Fire Apparatus Driver/ Operator Wildland
- Fire Apparatus Driver/ Operator Water Tender
- Fire Fighter II
- Rescue System 1
- Water Rescue Awareness
- Division/Group Supervisor
- Strike Team/Task Force Leader (CICCS)
- Safety Officer
- Fire Investigator
- ALS Paramedic Certification
- Fire Service Instructor

Special Requirements:

Must be able to serve in the capacity of "All-Risk" – "All Hazard" incident command capacity.

Applicant must have a satisfactory driving record that will allow the individual to be insurable with the Fire Department's insurance company.

Persons seeking appointment to this class must meet the safety health and physical condition standards deemed necessary and proper for performance of the duties established by the Fire Department.

Physical Requirements and Environmental Conditions: